

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

**Interconnection of Large Loads to the)
Interstate Transmission System**

Docket No. RM26-4-000

**COMMENTS OF THE
AMERICAN PUBLIC GAS ASSOCIATION**

Pursuant to the Notice of Inviting Comment issued by the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (“FERC” or “Commission”) on October 27, 2025, the American Public Gas Association (“APGA”) respectfully submits these comments in this proceeding.

I. COMMUNICATIONS

All correspondence and other communications filed in this proceeding should be addressed to:

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II. IDENTITY AND INTEREST

APGA is the trade association for more than 730 communities across the U.S. that own and operate their retail gas distribution entities. Overall, there are approximately 1,000 publicly- and community-owned systems in the United States. These include not-for-profit gas distribution systems owned by municipalities and other local government entities, all accountable to the citizens they serve. Public gas systems safely provide reliable, affordable, and sustainable energy

to their customers and support their communities by delivering fuel to be used for cooking, clothes drying, and space and water heating, as well as for various commercial and industrial applications, including electricity generation.¹

A not-for-profit public gas system gives a community local control over how gas is provided to homes and businesses. Instead of being made in a distant city, decisions are made at the community-level through citizen participation by people who appreciate local issues and who are primarily focused on service, safety, reliability, and costs. Public gas systems are regulated by their consumer-owners through locally elected governing boards or appointed officials, which are accountable to the citizen ratepayers they serve and removable by them. Accordingly, community aid and quality service are the mandates for these utilities.

While APGA members are not responsible for the construction of interstate transmission pipelines that are subject to FERC's jurisdiction, they are necessary to safely and reliably distribute the natural gas transported by these pipelines to residential, commercial, and industrial customers. To serve the communities that govern them, APGA members purchase interstate natural gas transportation services from pipelines at rates and under terms and conditions that are regulated by the Commission. Most APGA members are also captive to a single pipeline. Therefore, APGA members and the communities they serve have an interest in the Commission's consideration of jurisdiction over the interconnection of large loads on both the electric and natural gas transmission systems.

¹ For more information, please visit www.apga.org.

III. BACKGROUND

On October 23, 2025, the Secretary of Energy (Secretary) released an advanced notice of proposed rulemaking (ANOPR) for consideration and final action by the Commission.² The Secretary asserted that in order “to user in a new era of American property, we must ensure all Americans and domestic industries have access to affordable, reliable, and secure electricity. To do this, large loads, including AI data centers, served by public utilities must be able to connect to the transmission system in a timely, orderly, and non-discriminatory manner.”

The Secretary states “the unprecedented current and expected growth of large loads seeking to interconnect to the transmission system, and to provide open access and non-discriminatory access to the transmission system, it has become necessary to standardize interconnection procedures and agreements for such loads, including those seeking to share a point of interconnection with new or existing generation facilities (hybrid facilities).”

The Secretary invites comments on a set of principles including transparency, timeliness, and non-discriminatory access to guide the Commission’s rulemaking procedures. APGA supports the Secretary’s emphasis on public engagement in shaping this rulemaking process. However, we are concerned that the current scope of the ANOPR overlooks the critical role natural gas infrastructure plays in supporting large electric loads.

IV. COMMENTS

APGA appreciates the opportunity to provide input on Secretary Wright’s directive to FERC regarding the interconnection of large electric loads to the interstate transmission system.

² <https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2025-10/403%20Large%20Loads%20Letter.pdf>

As AI data centers and other high-demand facilities continue to grow, many are relying on natural gas-fired generation to meet their energy needs. Because many of these gas-fired facilities may draw from interstate pipelines regulated by FERC, their energy use has implications for interstate commerce. Additionally, they may impact the reliability of the natural gas transmission system, creating downstream impacts on APGA members' ability to reliably and affordably serve their communities and customers.

APGA requests that as the Commission contemplate jurisdiction over large loads, they consider how these large loads may influence interstate natural gas markets and infrastructure. This includes evaluating the extent to which such facilities impact interstate commerce, even if they are not directly connected to the electric grid. Any policy changes must preserve public gas utilities' flexibility in exercising their firm transportation rights and protect their ability to serve residential and commercial customers. Without thoughtful planning and coordination, increased demand on pipelines could strain existing capacity and jeopardize the ability of public gas systems to meet their core obligation to serve. APGA urges the Commission to incorporate natural gas considerations into this rulemaking to support an energy future that safeguards the interests of public gas utilities and their customers.

V. CONCLUSION

APGA appreciates the opportunity to provide comments and respectfully requests that the Commission take into consideration these comments in this proposal.

Respectfully submitted,



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